Flower Dedication

The flowers adorning the sanctuary today are given in honor of our grandchildren, Manny, Natalie, & Foster.

— Don & Martha Guare

The flowers in the narthex are given in honor of Jan Pike for her 20 years of service to First Presbyterian Church. Thank you for blessing us with such beautiful music.

— With love from the Choir

Announcements

FPC Membership Class. This 4-week series is a vehicle for learning more about the Christian faith and First Presbyterian Church. Membership not only entails "who" we are, but also "what" we believe and "how" we are to serve. We will discuss the larger denomination the church is a part of, specific theological foundations, and what it means to be a part of the Body of Christ at First Presbyterian Church. The class meets Sunday mornings — October 18 & 25, November 1 & 8 — at 9:30 a.m. in the Fellowship Hall (on the NE corner of the campus). If you have any questions or need more information, please contact the church office.

Samaritan's Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children's wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs $10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Pat Palmer
Greeters — Mark & BJ Mazurkiewicz
Acolytes — Kathryn Moore & Sally Grace McCullough
Circle of Prayer — Malechi Doren & Jack Griffith
AV Engineer — Russell Smith
Ushers — Bubba Labas, Randy Lambert, Alan Smith, & Henry Labas
Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Robert & Sallie Kate Williams, Katy Stanley, & Peter & Leslie Fisher
Children's Church — Dr. Micah & Courtney Monaghan

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor
Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship
Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care
Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries
Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women's Min. & Comm.
Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director
Jan Pike - Choir Director
Malechi Doren - Accompanist
Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant
Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

October 18 Bow-Making Class, 3:30 p.m.
October 20 Messy Bible Study, 8:00 a.m.
October 21 Kids Quest · Youth House · Messy Bible Study
October 22 Joy Riders Trip to Dixon Gardens in Memphis
October 25 Commitment Sunday for the Every Member Canvass

Online Giving

Scan to give online

919 East Shiloh Rd · Corinth, MS 38834 · fpccorinth.org · 662-286-6638

FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

October 18, 2026

Twenty-first Sunday after Pentecost

"To be disciples, to make disciples"

A congregation of the Evangelical Presbyterian Church

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew, or scan the QR code and submit it on your phone. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children's Church during the service. Children's bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God's Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by "Being Disciples and Making Disciples."

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

"Restored by Grace: Unfinished Business"

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 10:18–44

At the beginning of chapter 10, Ezra is confronted with a terrible spiritual crisis. The people, including some of their leaders, have entered into marriages that violate God's covenant commands and threaten to draw the community away from the Lord. This is not a minor administrative problem, but a matter of covenant faithfulness and the spiritual future of God's people. We saw that genuine repentance produces a willingness to obey God, even when obedience is difficult and costly.

Now, in the passage today, Ezra records the names of those who were involved in this covenant violation. The list is sobering. It reminds us that sin had reached deeply into the life of the restored community, including among those who should have known better. Then, rather abruptly, the book ends. There is no grand announcement that the people have finally become completely faithful. There is no declaration that Israel's spiritual struggles are over. There is no picture of a perfect community living in unbroken obedience to God. Why would God give us a book that ends this way?

I. Grace Calls for Real Repentance (vv. 18–24)

II. Grace Preserves a Holy Remnant (vv. 25–44)

III. Grace Points Us to the Finished Redemption of Christ

Resources: Matthew Henry's Commentary, Vol. 2, Matthew Henry; Ezra & Nehemiah, Derek Kidner; Ezra & Nehemiah, Jacob M. Myers; Westminster Confession of Faith

THE LORD'S SUPPER
The Lord's Supper is a means of grace in which Christ spiritually nourishes believers, strengthening their faith as they partake of the bread and cup in union with Him. We reflect on how thankful we are for the work of Christ on our behalf, and we pray that his grace would work more powerfully in our lives to change us more into his likeness. The sacrament is a tangible, concrete gift where we can physically remember the goodness of the gospel story.

The Sacrament of the Lord's Supper
Invitation to the Table

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Gracious Father, we confess that we have not always lived in the newness of life that is ours in Christ. We are often content with partial obedience, clinging to our sins rather than turning from them. Forgive us for loving the things of this world more than we love You and for failing to reflect Your holiness in our lives. Thank You that Christ died for us while we were still sinners and that, through Him, we have been reconciled to You. By Your Spirit, grant us genuine repentance, renewed hearts, and joyful obedience, that we may live as Your redeemed people until the day You make all things new.

Silent Confession

PRAYER OF CONFESSION
Our worship moves from adoration to grace, to confession, then assurance, and finally to the Table. This prayer intentionally acknowledges our tendency toward self-reliance while anticipating the grace that Christ offers in the Sacrament.

Assurance of Pardon: Psalm 103:11–12

"For as high as the heavens are above the earth, so great is his steadfast love toward those who fear him; as far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions from us."

The Words of Institution: 1 Corinthians 11:23–29
Partaking of the Elements
Prayer of Thanksgiving

SENDING

***Hymn of Commitment: #546** *"For All the Saints"*

***Benediction**

BENEDICTION
God's people are blessed by the Lord and sent forth into the world, bearing with them the hope and peace of the Gospel. As we continue our worship, we do so as people sent to our community for reconciliation, bearing witness to the good news of the gospel.

***Choral Benediction** *"Go Now in Peace"*

***Postlude**

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD

October 18, 2026

** Indicates congregation standing if able*

GATHERING

Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.

The Piano Prelude

Greetings & Announcements

Call to Meditation: Psalm 25:4–5

"Make me to know your ways, O Lord; teach me your paths. Lead me in your truth and teach me, for you are the God of my salvation; for you I wait all the day long."

The Prelude

Choral Introit *"In Your House"*

***Scriptural Call to Worship:** Revelation 21:1–5

Leader: Hear the Word of the Lord, who declares His promise to make all things new: "Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away, and the sea was no more. And I saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying,

All: *"Behold, the dwelling place of God is with man. He will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and God himself will be with them as their God. He will wipe away every tear from their eyes, and death shall be no more, neither shall there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain anymore, for the former things have passed away."*

Leader: And he who was seated on the throne said, "Behold, I am making all things new."

All: *To the glory of God, let us worship!*

CALL TO WORSHIP
We are summoned to worship by God's word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth, opening a sacred conversation that unfolds throughout the service. We sing in response to God's call to worship, which is a reminder that worship is at God's initiative, not ours.

THE CHURCH'S ONE FOUNDATION
In this hymn, written by Samuel Stone in 1866, we sing of Christ's redeemed Church, who awaits the day when He will gather His people from every age and nation into eternal glory. Though the Church now struggles and suffers, Christ will preserve her until the final redemption, when she will dwell with Him forever in the new heavens and new earth.

***The Hymn: #277** *"The Church's One Foundation"*

***Prayer of Invocation & The Lord's Prayer**

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

***The New Testament Reading:** Romans 5:6–11

Leader: For while we were still weak, at the right time Christ died for the ungodly. For one will scarcely die for a righteous person — though perhaps for a good person one would dare even to die — but God shows his love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us. Since, therefore, we have now been justified by his blood, much more shall we be saved by him from the wrath of God. For if while we were enemies we were reconciled to God by the death of his Son, much more, now that we are reconciled, shall we be saved by his life. More than that, we also rejoice in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have now received reconciliation. This is the Word of the Lord.

All: *Thanks be to God.*

***Congregational Response: #208** *"Alas, and Did My Savior Bleed?" (vv. 1–3)*

WORD

Every Member Canvass *Dr. John Shipp*
Chairman

"But as you excel in everything — in faith, in speech, in knowledge, in all earnestness, and in our love for you — see that you excel in this act of grace also." *2 Corinthians 8:7*

dGroup Story of Grace

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

The Offertory

***The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication**

Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

***Children Dismissed to Children's Church**

CHILDREN'S CHURCH
Children ages 4 up to 4th grade are invited to come forward and exit out the side door for Children's Church. Following the worship service, they may be picked up in the Fellowship Hall.

Scripture Reading *Ezra 10:18–44 · Pew Bible, p. 397*

Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;

All: *The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.*

Sermon: *"Restored by Grace: Unfinished Business"* *Rev. Waring Porter*

Prayer of Commitment

Choral Anthem *"Communion Meditation"*
Jay Althouse